

TESSERA

Live on Arc testnet · USDC-native

Money for machines.

Trustless pay-per-use commerce for AI agents — plus the DeFi rails that fund it. Settled on Arc in USDC.

Live on Arc testnet

chainId 5042002 · USDC as gas

8 contracts deployed

escrow, tabs, pool, vault, swap, AMM, 2
collectors

225 automated tests

104 contract · 121 agent · CI on every push

THE PROBLEM

Agents can't pay strangers.

An agent can only buy from a service a human already onboarded.

Trust runs both ways

The service can't tell the agent will pay. The agent can't tell the service will deliver.

So: pre-funded vendors only

Agents are boxed into a hand-curated list of pre-approved suppliers.

That isn't an economy

Machine-to-machine commerce needs strangers to transact safely.

THE INSIGHT

The missing primitive isn't “send USDC.” It's escrow + SLA + reputation.

A raw transfer doesn't make a stranger safe to deal with.
Programmable escrow — with a delivery guarantee and staked reputation attached — does.

HOW IT WORKS

402 → decide → escrow → settle or refund

USDC is Arc's gas token, so the agent funds one asset for both the toll and the fees — and sub-second finality lets a payment settle inside the request.

01 Quote

Agent hits a paid endpoint → HTTP 402 plus an EIP-712 signed USDC price and SLA.

02 Decide

Rules (optionally an LLM) weigh budget, on-chain reputation, bonded stake and the agent's own memory.

03 Escrow

Locks a nano-sized USDC payment in TesseractEscrow on Arc.

04 Settle / refund

Delivered → released. SLA breach → reclaimed, and the provider's stake is slashed.

WHAT MAKES IT REAL

| Guarantees, not promises.

Escrow + auto-refund

Delivery releases funds; an SLA breach reclaims them. Enforced by the contract.

Provider staking and slashing

Providers bond USDC. A breach slashes it to compensate the agent — real downside.

Nanopayment tabs

One deposit, many zero-gas signed vouchers, one settlement. Streams at nano-scale.

Guardian + trust memory

Large buys pause for a human co-signer; a provider that failed this agent is declined next time.

The rails that fund the agent.

An agent needs working capital. Tessera provides it natively rather than assuming a funded wallet.

Lending & borrowing

Supply for yield or borrow against collateral. Kinked-utilisation interest, health-factor liquidation, per-action freeze controls.

Yield vault

80% held liquid by a contract floor no admin can lower. The app's fee touches yield only — never principal.

Swap desk

Oracle-priced swaps between pool assets, with the fee split configurable.

Liquidity pools (AMM)

Multi-asset pools where providers keep at least 50% of every swap fee — a constant in the contract, not a setting.

What an operator cannot do.

The safety properties that matter are the ones written as constants, not as policy.

Vault reserve floor

80% liquid is a contract constant. Raising it is allowed; lowering it is not.

AMM provider share

50% of swap fees to liquidity providers, enforced on every configuration path.

No position transfers

No function anywhere lets an operator move someone else's position. Migration pays in on their behalf instead.

Oracle validation

A stale, negative, unfinished or carried-over price pauses the market rather than pricing wrongly.

Freeze, not trap

Freezing is per action — withdraw and repay can stay open, and liquidation is never frozen.

Live information the agent can act on.

News across 21 topics, FX, crypto, stocks, indices, commodities, and market analysis derived from those prices.

Named sources

ECB reference rates, CoinGecko, Yahoo Finance, public RSS. Each panel names its source and its age.

Never a fabricated number

An unreachable feed says so. It does not fall back to a stale figure someone might trade on.

Analysis, not opinion

Breadth, leaders, laggards, volatility, dollar direction — arithmetic on the prices shown, no forecasts.

Full transaction history

Filter by user, date, range, value, outcome and type; export to CSV.

LIVE RUN

One autonomous run, four outcomes.

Nothing here is scripted — this is what the agent decided on its own.

Settled

Weather and FX-quote calls delivered against their SLA and released automatically.

Refunded + slashed

A news service returned junk. The agent reclaimed its USDC and slashed the provider's bond.

Guardian pause

A premium call exceeded the per-call policy cap, so a human co-signed before it settled.

Declined from memory

A later invoice from the provider that had failed it was declined without asking anyone.

Deployed and transacting on Arc testnet.

Chain

Arc testnet, chainId 5042002, bound to native USDC at 0x3600...0000.

Contracts

Escrow, nanopayment tabs, lending pool, vault, swap desk, AMM, and two fee collectors.

Verified transactions

Settle, refund (SLA breach reclaimed), and a tab settled in one on-chain claim.

Real assets

USDC, EURC and cirBTC — Circle's own tokens on Arc, not mocks.

| The chain makes the product possible.

USDC as gas

One asset funds both the purchase and the fee. No separate gas token to manage.

Sub-second finality

A payment can settle inside the HTTP request that triggered it.

Stablecoin-native

Prices in the unit the invoice is denominated in — no FX exposure between quote and settlement.

Config, not fork

Chain id, RPC, explorer and USDC address are all env-driven; mainnet is a configuration change.

| Every feature runs end to end.

225 automated tests

104 contract tests on Hardhat plus 121 agent unit tests, in CI on every push.

Browser and API QA

Interaction, responsiveness across five viewport widths, and a security sweep of every endpoint.

Security posture documented

Findings, fixes, guardrails, and the residual risks stated plainly in docs/SECURITY.md.

Self-custody by default

Calldata is built in the browser and signed by the user's wallet. The server never holds a user key.

THE VISION

| The settlement rail for agent-to-agent commerce.

When agents transact continuously, the bottleneck is not intelligence — it is trust between strangers. Tessera is that layer, and it settles in USDC on Arc.